IMPACT DESK · SALES ENABLEMENT · INTERNAL

What it takes to run this on real data

The dashboard is built and working today on sample data. Going live with a client's real influencers comes down to **one dependency**: a licensed data feed. This brief explains that dependency in plain terms — and how to sell around it.

Prepared for **Rob Rusche** Date **Jul 6, 2026** Re: **Influencer Impact Dashboard (MVP)**

What the product does, in one breath

It ranks influencers by their **typical** post performance — the median — instead of the average. That matters because averages lie: an account with nine dead posts and one viral hit *averages* 100,000 views but is not a real influencer. The dashboard sees through that, ranks the genuinely consistent performers first, and flags the inflated ones as **outlier-driven**. It replaces the client's 50-tab spreadsheet with something a non-technical operator — and their clients — can actually read.

1 Readiness at a glance

Almost everything is done. The board below is the honest status — five parts built and working, one part waiting on a business decision.

Ranking engine (median-first) ● BUILT	Dashboards & charts ● BUILT	Operator & client views ● BUILT	Manual / CSV data entry ● BUILT
CSV export ● BUILT	Live data feed (vendor) ● DECISION		

"Built" means running now and demoable on realistic sample data. The single pending item is not engineering work — it's choosing and paying for a data source.

2 The one dependency

THE THING STANDING BETWEEN DEMO AND GO-LIVE

A provider that gives us, per influencer, the last ~20 posts with a view count on every post.

Social platforms deliberately make this data hard to get, and scraping them violates their terms. The industry answer is a third-party **data aggregator** that licenses this information and exposes it through an API. The app was built specifically so that feed plugs in without rebuilding anything — it's a swap, not a project.

Why views specifically: median *views* per post is the headline ranking number. Likes and comments are useful, but a provider that can't deliver per-post views can't power this product — so that's the one field to confirm before signing anything.

3 Exactly what a vendor must deliver

In plain terms — this is the checklist to hand a prospective data provider. Looked up by public handle, no cooperation from the influencer required.

WHAT WE NEED	PRIORITY	WHAT IT'S FOR
Views — per post, last ~20	DEAL-BREAKER	The primary ranking number (median views)
Likes — per post	IMPORTANT	Engagement & engagement-rate metrics
Comments — per post	IMPORTANT	Engagement calculation
Post date	IMPORTANT	Selecting the “last 20” posts
Follower count	IMPORTANT	Macro / micro / nano tier split
Shares — per post	NICE TO HAVE	Sharpens the engagement number
Post ID + display name	NICE TO HAVE	Clean refreshes & nicer labels

Everything else the dashboard shows — medians, averages, engagement rate, the "who's real" flag — the app calculates itself. We don't need the vendor to score anything.

4 The vendor landscape

A shortlist from market research. Figures are **rough public estimates, not quotes** — real pricing comes from a conversation with each vendor.

VENDOR	EST. ANNUAL COST	FIT FOR US
Modash (Raw API)	~$10k+	**Best fit.** Returns live per-post metrics for any public profile — matches our need most directly. Start here.
CreatorDB	Quote-based	Cheaper; strong historical data. Confirm per-post *view* depth in a trial.
Click Analytic	Pay-per-call	Priced per lookup — attractive for low volume. Verify per-post views.
Phyllo & consent-based APIs	—	**Wrong model.** Requires each influencer to log in and connect their own account. We evaluate influencers the client *doesn't* manage, so this doesn't apply.

5 The compliance story — for client conversations

Terms-of-use worry came up on the call. Here's the honest, reassuring version to give a client: the product **never scrapes** TikTok, Instagram, or YouTube. It uses **licensed data from a third-party aggregator** — the compliant, industry-standard route. That's precisely how it stays within "the letter and spirit" of the platforms' terms while still getting the numbers the client needs.

One caveat to keep internal: data licensing is ultimately the vendor's responsibility, so we confirm each vendor's compliance posture as part of selecting them — it's on the decision list below, not left to chance.

6 Open decisions — business, not engineering

Four calls the team (with the client) needs to make. None of them block the demo; all of them are needed before go-live.

A **Pick a data vendor & approve the budget.** Ballpark ~$10k/year. This is the gating decision.

B **Confirm the "engagement" definition** with the operator — likes + comments + shares, or a weighted version. It's adjustable in the app; we just need his preference.

C **Set the macro-vs-micro follower thresholds.** Where does "micro" end and "macro" begin for this client's world?

D **Name the target platforms & a few real influencers** to use for the trial below.

7 What you can say today

> "The dashboard is built and working — I can show it to you live right now on sample data."

> "To switch to your real influencers, we plug in a licensed data feed. No scraping, fully within the platforms' terms."

> "One short, low-cost trial confirms the data covers your influencers — then we're live."

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Run one paid vendor trial before committing

Don't sign an annual contract on faith. A **2–4 week paid trial with one vendor** (recommend Modash) against **~10 real handles** the client cares about confirms the single thing that matters — per-post view coverage on their platforms. Low cost, and it de-risks the entire build before any big spend.

STEP 1	STEP 2	STEP 3
Pick 10 real influencers	**Trial one vendor**	**Confirm & commit**

On the client's target platforms.	Check: does every post return views, likes, comments, date?	Coverage good → sign & go live. Gaps → try the next vendor.

Impact Desk — internal sales brief. Prototype runs today on sample data; figures are market estimates pending vendor quotes.

Questions on the technical side → the build team. This document covers the business decisions only.